

PROJECT PLAN

Community of Kindness – Fremantle’s Ikigai

Draft prepared for the Villa Dalmacia Grants Program

1. Project Background

The Community of Kindness is an emerging grassroots, community-led initiative focused on strengthening social inclusion, wellbeing, practical support and community resilience within Fremantle, Western Australia.

The initiative has developed through recurring community lunches, outreach efforts and volunteer-led support activities coordinated by Freya Cheffers and supported by local volunteers, suppliers, St John’s Anglican Church, businesses and community members.

The project seeks to create a welcoming community environment where vulnerable and socially isolated individuals can access practical support, reconnect socially, participate in meaningful activities and contribute positively to the wider community.

2. Project Purpose

The purpose of the project is to establish a sustainable, community-led initiative that promotes dignity, participation, wellbeing and community connection for people experiencing hardship, homelessness, isolation or difficult life circumstances.

Inspired by the concept of “ikigai” (reason for being), the initiative aims to create opportunities for belonging, contribution, practical support and meaningful community participation within Fremantle.

3. Project Objectives

- Deliver 52 weekly community gatherings over a 12-month period.
- Provide recurring food support and shared community meals.
- Reduce social isolation and improve community wellbeing.
- Encourage volunteering and reciprocal community participation.
- Deliver practical workshops and skills-sharing activities.
- Establish community gardening and sustainability activities.
- Strengthen partnerships with local businesses, suppliers, faith groups and volunteers.
- Develop governance systems and organisational capacity for long-term sustainability.

4. Target Beneficiaries

The initiative is designed to support:

- People experiencing homelessness or housing insecurity;

- Individuals experiencing financial hardship or social isolation;
- Young people at risk of disengagement;
- People from culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) backgrounds;
- Individuals experiencing mental health challenges or emotional distress;
- Vulnerable creatives and community members seeking connection and purpose; and
- Members of the wider community seeking opportunities for volunteering and positive social contribution.

5. Key Project Activities

The project will deliver the following core activities:

- Weekly community lunches and gatherings in Fremantle;
- Food support and distribution of donated goods;
- Volunteer coordination and outreach activities;
- Peer connection and wellbeing support activities;
- Skills-sharing workshops and vocational pathway activities;
- Community gardening and sustainability initiatives;
- Creative and cultural engagement activities; and
- Partnership-building with community organisations and local suppliers.

6. Project Timeline

Period	Activity	Outcome
Jul – Aug 2026	Governance setup, website launch and partnerships	Project establishment completed
Aug – Sep 2026	Commencement of weekly gatherings	Community sessions operational
Sep 2026 – Jun 2027	Weekly lunches, workshops and outreach	Ongoing support delivery
Quarterly	Data collection and reporting	Monitoring completed
May – Jun 2027	Final reporting and future funding applications	Continuation planning completed

7. Governance & Personnel

Key personnel include:

- Freya Cheffers – Project Lead / Community Liaison;
- Emma – Treasurer
- Alexander Buck – Secretary and legal compliance
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8. Budget Summary

Item	Grant Funding	In-Kind Support
Community Session Coordination	\$52,000	—

Community Garden Activities	\$500	—
Governance & Registration	\$200	—
Website & Digital Presence	\$500	Design support
Venue / Community Space	\$0	~\$26,000
Food & Essential Supplies	\$0	~\$26,000
Recycled Clothing Program	\$0	~\$5,000

9. Monitoring & Evaluation

Success will be measured through:

- attendance records;
- meals and food support distribution logs;
- volunteer participation hours;
- workshop delivery records;
- participant feedback and wellbeing surveys;
- testimonials and case studies;
- partnership tracking; and
- quarterly reporting.

10. Long-Term Sustainability

The Community of Kindness is intended to continue beyond the grant period through volunteer participation, in-kind support from local suppliers and businesses, community fundraising, future grants and collaborative partnerships with community organisations and faith groups.

The project already demonstrates strong grassroots momentum through recurring community meals, supplier support and volunteer engagement within Fremantle.